

DUE

Deadline for Unfinished Essays

Description:

DUE is a collaborative platform for short-form essays written under pressure. Writers begin by proposing a topic, then have **30 days** to complete an essay within a chosen word range—**250–500**, **500–1000**, or **1000–1500** words. Once the deadline hits, the essay is published—finished or not.

Unfinished drafts are not failures; they're invitations. Readers can suggest edits, additions, or continuations. Meaningful contributions earn coauthor credit, transforming solitary writing into an evolving collaborative process.

Contributor Guidelines

Welcome to DUE – Deadline for Unfinished Essays

This platform is an experiment in constraint, collaboration, and letting go of perfection. Here's how to participate.

1. Propose a Topic, Start the Clock

- Once you propose a topic, you have **30 days** to complete your essay.
- Essays must fall into one of three word ranges:
 - *250–500 words*
 - *500–1000 words*
 - *1000–1500 words*
- You can only work on **one essay at a time**. Use your time wisely.

2. Publish, Ready or Not

- When 30 days are up, your essay is **automatically published**—finished or not.
- There is no "archive" button. There is no "maybe later."
Your ideas go live as they are.

3. Unfinished ≠ Unworthy

- An unfinished essay is not a failure. It's a start.
- Readers are invited to suggest:
 - Edits

- Expansions
- Conclusions
- Structural improvements

4. Versioning and Evolution

- Every essay, whether finished or not, is a **living document**.
- When an essay is published:
 - If the author considers it **complete**, it begins at **version 1.0**
 - If the essay is **unfinished**, it begins at **version 0.1**
- Any accepted edits or contributions will trigger version updates:
 - **Minor edits** → version bump to **1.1, 1.2**, etc.
 - **Major contributions** → version bump to **2.0, 3.0**, etc.
- Readers can always access previous versions and track the evolution of the essay.

5. Credit Where It's Due

- **Minor contributions**—such as grammatical corrections, improving phrasing, suggesting examples, or adding references—will be recognized in the **Acknowledgments** section.
- **Major contributions**—such as adding large sections, reworking the argument, or reframing the message—should be rewarded with **coauthorship**.
- The original author determines the level of contribution, but we encourage generosity, humility, and collaboration.

6. Respect the Platform and the People

- Be kind, constructive, and intellectually honest.
- Hate speech, plagiarism, spam, and personal attacks are not tolerated.
- You retain rights to your own writing but agree to let others build on your published work within this platform.

7. Release Control, Embrace the Deadline

- This is not about polishing forever.
- It's about writing with urgency, publishing bravely, and letting others in—even after you're “done.”